

First Read

China Industrials

Shipping supply chain weekly: trade flows, freight and Hormuz updates (week 28)

Key highlights from high-frequency data

We compile weekly data from UBS Evidence Lab, the Ministry of Transport and other third-party data providers to track the latest trade flows across shipping, shipbuilding and ports.

Uncertainties remains at Hormuz Strait

Transits in Hormuz Strait have eased back, with an average of 30 vessels transited per day last week, down from 45 per day across the first week of July. Our Maritime Trade Disruption Monitor ([> Access Dataset](#)) indicated a notable decrease in the oil tankers departing eastbound from Hormuz from July 8th. VLCC average earnings from Middle East/West Africa to China strengthened last week with resurgence of VLCC activity in the USG, with Middle East/US Gulf/West Africa-China VLCC TCE +65%/+0%/-14% vs. pre-conflict level.

Container shipping volume and rates eased

Container throughput at key ports in China decreased 15% WoW and 11% YoY last week under the impact of Typhoon. After hitting the intra-year high, main lane freight rates softened last week: overall SCFI freight rates decreased by 4% WoW last week (+84% YoY), with Shanghai-Europe -3% WoW and Transpacific -2-6% WoW; Port of LA imports were decreased 3% YoY in week 28 and estimated to increased 14% YoY in week 29. Intra-Asia containership chartering index increased by 1.7% WoW last week.

BDI & earnings of bulker and new build price remained elevated

The bulker market surged again this week, with average earnings of capesize increasing 15%, supported by robust demand in the Pacific. The shipbuilding newbuild price index maintained upward momentum and CNPI hit record high in June, with sustained demand for tanker and bulker.

Equities

China
Industrial

Robin Xu

Analyst
bin.xu@ubs.com
+86-21-3866 8872

Zed Sheng

Analyst
S1460525030003
zed.sheng@ubs.com
+86-21-3866 8730

Cristian Nedelcu, CFA

Analyst
cristian.nedelcu@ubs.com
+44-20-7568 4375

William Deng

Economist
william-w.deng@ubs.com
+852-2971 6765

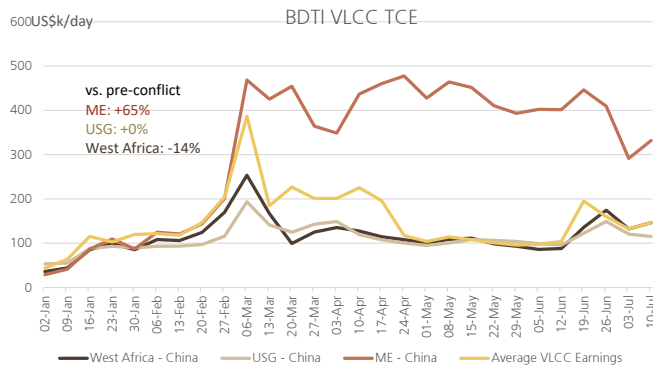
Xin Chen

Analyst
S1460511050002
xin.chen@ubs.com
+86-21-3866 8864

Bruce Mi

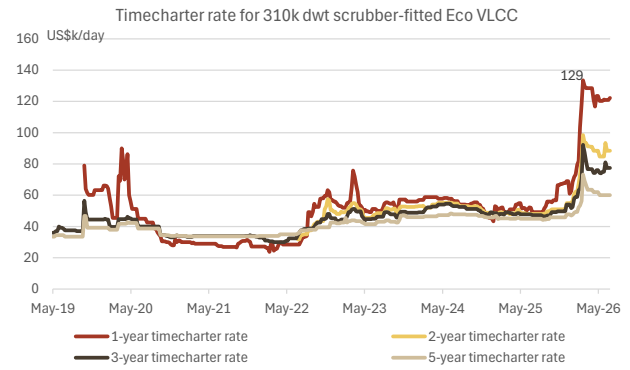
Analyst
S1460522060001
bruce.mi@ubs.com
+86-21-3866 8851

Figure 1: Middle East/US Gulf/West Africa-China VLCC TCE +65%/+0%/-14% vs. pre-conflict level



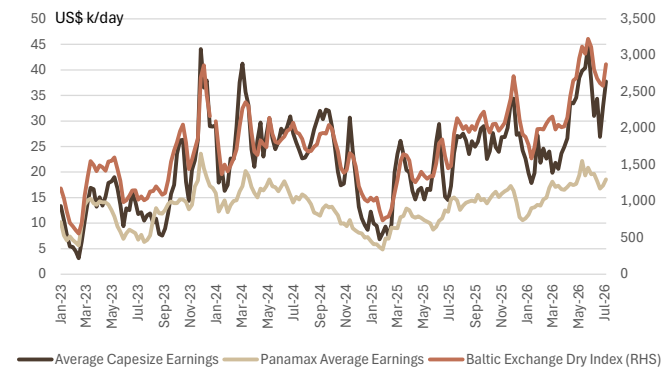
Source: Clarksons, data as of 10 July

Figure 2: VLCC 1 year charter rate remained stable



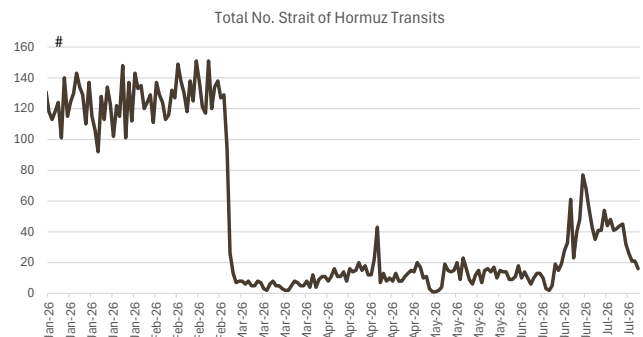
Source: Clarksons, data as of 10 July

Figure 3: Average earnings of Capesize increased by 15% WoW last week



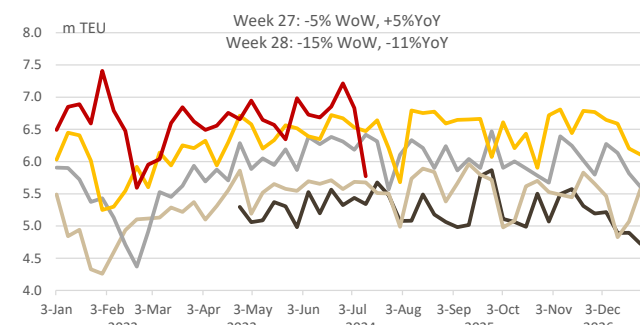
Source: Clarksons, data as of 10 July

Figure 4: Vessels passage at Hormuz fall below 20 per day last week, below pre-conflict level



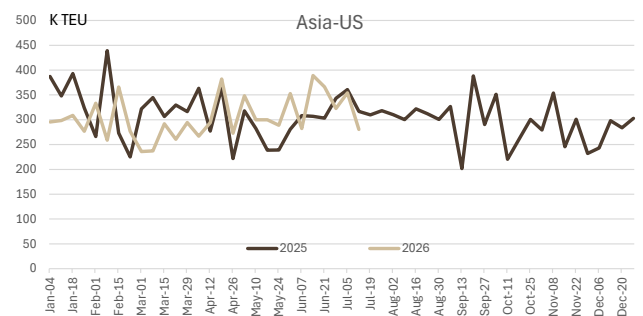
Source: Clarksons, data as of 10 July

Figure 5: Container throughput at China's key ports -15% WoW, -11% YoY last week



Source: Ministry of Transport

Figure 6: Container volume new in transit from Asia to US fall notably last week



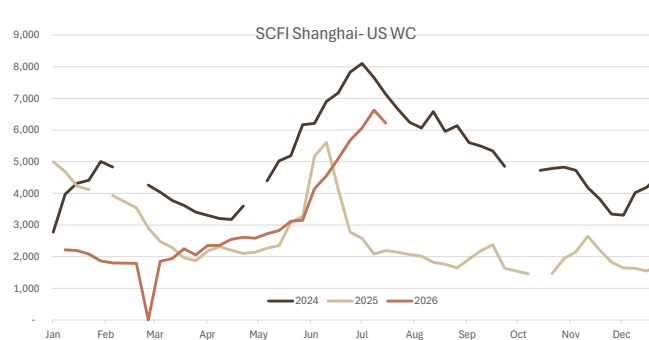
Source: UBS Evidence Lab ([Access Dataset](#))

Figure 7: SCFI -4% WoW and +84% YoY

WoW/YoY	SCFI	CCFI	SCFI Europe	SCFI W/C US	SCFI E/C US	NCFI Thailand&Vietnam
2026-06-05	6%/22%	3%/22%	5%/56%	10%/-19%	8%/-17%	-5%/10%
2026-06-12	9%/43%	5%/19%	18%/66%	12%/24%	10%/-6%	-5%/11%
2026-06-19	5%/67%	8%/19%	3%/72%	11%/105%	9%/28%	-11%/4%
2026-06-26	4%/74%	7%/25%	6%/65%	7%/135%	7%/57%	-3%/3%
2026-07-03	3%/89%	6%/35%	2%/63%	9%/217%	12%/101%	-5%/1%
2026-07-10	-4%/84%	3%/43%	-3%/59%	-6%/183%	-2%/95%	-12%/-6%

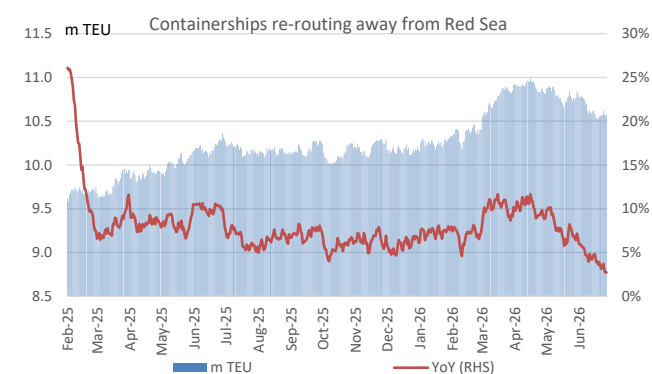
Source: Shanghai Shipping Exchange, Clarksons, data as of 10 July 2026

Figure 8: SCFI Shanghai-WC America Container Freight Rate -6% WoW and 183% YoY



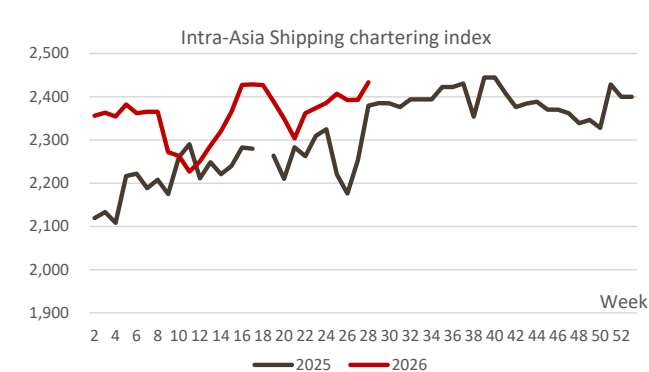
Source: Clarksons; Note: data as of 10 July 2026

Figure 9: Container ships re-routing away from Red Sea still at high levels (+2-5% YoY)



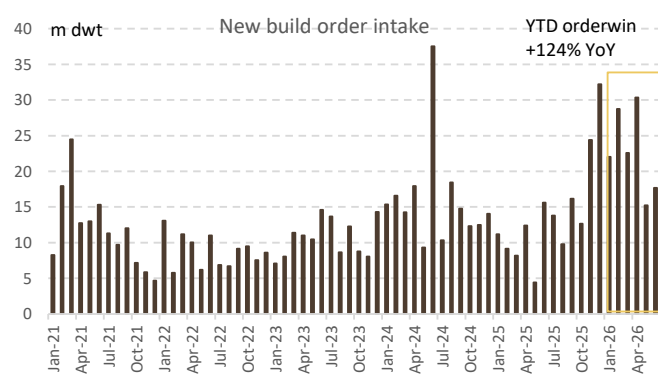
Source: Clarksons; Note: data as of 10 July 2026

Figure 10: Intra-Asia chartering index +1.7% last week



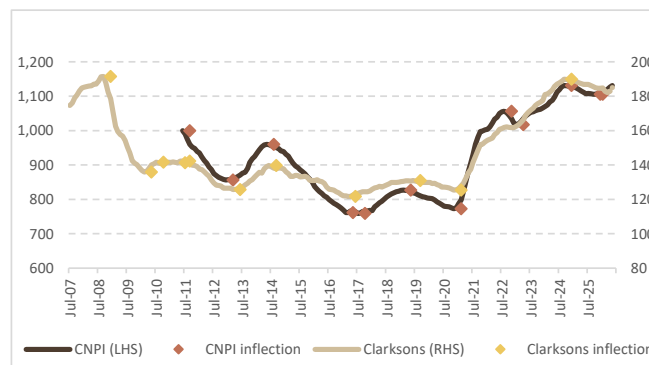
Source: Company data

Figure 11: Strong VLCC demand drives up YTD strong global shipbuilding demand



Source: Clarksons

Figure 12: Both Clarksons and CNPI indicate new build price remain elevated



Source: Clarksons, CNPI, as of 10 July 2026

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Daily Maritime Trade Disruption Monitor ([>Access Dataset](#))

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Source: UBS. Rating allocations are as of 30 June 2026.

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